DeepRoots Bible: Impact, Growth & the Case for Automation

Talking points for donor presentation · Prepared for Dan Williamson · November 2026

Who we reach today

- **Reach:** 78,000+ students in 384 Christian schools use DeepRoots (2025-26 school year, invoiced accounts).
- **Loyalty:** Roughly 90% of schools renew year after year. Once a school adopts DeepRoots, it stays.
- **Footprint:** Six regional sales territories serve schools nationwide.
- **Grades:** PreK–6 today, with Grade 7 rolling out now (already in 54 schools with 84 Grade 7 teachers). PreK is planned for fall 2027.
- **Context:** Our closest school-focused peer, Summit Ministries, reports about 60,000 students in 600+ schools. DeepRoots already reaches more students.

Demand is growing

- **Interest:** Nearly 2,000 schools and teachers have requested sample units through our website since 2017.
- **Trend:** Requests grew more than 3× from 2017 to the 2020–22 peak (296 in 2022).
- **Momentum:** 2026 already has 242 requests, up 58% on all of 2025, and Q3 2026 was the strongest quarter on record (112 requests).
- **Vision:** Long-term goal: grow from ~80,000 to 350,000 students as PreK and new grades launch.

What makes DeepRoots different

- **Kids master Scripture through play:** Treehouse Adventure is a Scripture-memory game for grades 4–6 with a teacher progress dashboard. Of the 14 Bible curricula we reviewed, no other school curriculum offers a student game.
- **Distinctive design:** Painted Bible-epic artwork, a parent/home login, and a curriculum built to run as a sequence across all grades.
- **Our message:** Position: "The Bible curriculum where kids master Scripture through play, and teachers can see it happen."

Why automation matters: the problem today

- Our website is a brochure with no back end. Enrollment, renewals, marketing, support, editorial and reporting are all done by hand across email, spreadsheets and separate tools.
- In the last 12 months staff hand-logged 8,684 emails. Each school takes about 10 manual steps to go from "yes" to "teaching."
- Every new school adds more manual work. Growth means hiring, and leadership reports are out of date by the time they are compiled.
- Curriculum is written, edited and assembled by hand. Scripture passages are pasted and formatted manually (one study guide alone has 1,000+ verses), and versions are tracked in documents and email.

What the new DeepRoots Portal changes

- **Internal operations:** One system and one login for schools, staff and sales, with automatic setup, renewals, invoicing and onboarding. Most schools go from about 10 manual steps to none.
- **Capacity:** Returns an estimated ~960 staff hours a year (about half a full-time position), mostly in the May–August rush. The company can grow without adding staff at the same rate.
- **Sales:** Schools accept quotes and renew online. Renewal notices go out 90 days ahead, and every website enquiry reaches the right ambassador instantly. Each 1-point gain in renewal rate is worth about $13,000 a year, every year.

- **Marketing agility:** Marketing updates the website itself and runs email and social campaigns on a schedule with open and click tracking. Leaders see a live dashboard of pipeline, renewals, conversions and return on each conference, so we can see what works and shift quickly.
- **Curriculum turnaround:** A planned editorial workflow puts drafting, automatic Scripture insertion (via the licensed ESV service), review, approval and publishing in one place with automatic version control. AI-assisted alignment of learning objectives across grades shortens revisions. Updated lessons can reach classrooms digitally, without waiting on a long manual production cycle.
- **Timeline:** Preview in November 2026, first go-live in December 2026, department phases January–February 2027, and full handover in March 2027.

Where donor gifts make the biggest difference

- **Finish the automation:** Complete the remaining portal phases, especially the editorial/curriculum workflow, so content improvements reach schools faster.
- **New grades:** Finish Grade 8, launch PreK, and then build Grades 9–12. Leadership has identified this as donor-funded work.
- **Engagement tools:** Expand Treehouse and digital resources that keep kids engaged with Scripture.
- **Proposed "Holy Land Student Ambassadors":** Students film short video lessons at biblical sites, with a teacher or scholar on camera. Estimated $91,000 per 8-day trip with 10 students: about $5,520 to sponsor one student, or about $11,400 per finished video lesson (pending board go/no-go and travel advisories).
- **Why video:** Kids engage heavily with video. Tweens' daily online video time more than doubled from 2015 to 2019 (Common Sense Media), and 88% of parents say YouTube helps their child learn (Pew, 2020).